

Open Source Technology: First Love of the Leaders at AskMeBazaar.com!

For some, open source technology is a passion; for some, it is a mission and for start-ups, it is a necessity. **Ekta Mittal, head, product and technology, AskMeBazaar.com**, vouches for the fact that open source technologies can truly be the backbone of a tech based start-up like hers. Of course, cost saving makes open source technologies lucrative, but there are other factors too. **Diksha P. Gupta** from **Open Source For You** got in touch with Mittal to explore how start-ups like AskMeBazaar.com benefit from open source technologies. Read on...



Today, after the giant strides taken by open source technologies, you can no longer remain untouched by their magic. Start-ups like AskMeBazaar.com bank on the power of open source for their survival. When asked whether the company uses open source technologies, Ekta Mittal, head, product and technology, AskMeBazaar.com, emphatically states, “Yes, pretty much! We are firm believers in open source technology. Almost over 80 per cent of the technologies that we use in our environment are open source. We are currently working on building an e-commerce platform, in which we are using a lot of open source technologies, including the search platform, the caching technologies, the database, the login mechanism and supporting tools.”

AskMeBazaar is built on the LAMP stack. The tech head elaborates: “The two search platforms we use are Solr and Elastic Search, which are being extensively used these days by most of the companies. Redis is used for caching and Pentaho for reporting. And for detailed analytics and the loyalty programme that we are building, it’s MongoDB. We also work with partners like Unbxid, which is built on Elastic Search. Another partner is Vinculum, on which our seller panel is built. The entire e-commerce platform that we have on AskMeBazaar.com is based on OpenCart. So, open source is pretty much everywhere in AskMeBazaar.com.”

And here’s why AskMeBazaar.com uses open source tech...

Apart from factors like having a passion for open source and believing in the philosophy behind it, Mittal uses open source technology at AskMeBazaar.com for certain other reasons too. She says, “There are three key advantages that we get with open source technologies. The first and most important is that one gets control over the code of the software. Community support is another major reason why open source technology is my first choice. Most of the companies, including LinkedIn, Facebook, et al, have started contributing widely to open source technologies. Fluentd, which is a log aggregator, comes from the house of Facebook. I completely believe in the community culture and I want to build a similar culture at AskMeBazaar.com. Third, as the CTO, I have to look at the cost benefits and, with open source, this is one big advantage that any company gets.”

Mittal is not the only one in the company who thinks open source is the best fit. The entire management team backs her on this. She says, “As a company, we are pretty open to open source technologies. When we decide on what technology to use, we evaluate all our options and depending upon what is best with respect to security, we deploy that technology. For example, in the case of analytics tools, we use both Google Analytics and its open source alternative,